

Quiz 3 - Computational Physics I

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Date: Wednesday 30 April 2025

Duration: 45 minutes

Credits: 20 points (5 questions)

Type of evaluation: LAB

Provide concise answers to the following items:

1. (4 points) Numerical differentiation

- Indicate the sources of errors when computing the divergence of a 2D magnetic field: $\vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{B}$
- What defines the order of accuracy of a finite difference method?

a) we could have a

machine epsilon error: comes from the limits of processing information in computer in terms of bits to allocate

method error: gradient function uses the finite difference method which can have errors of first $O(h)$ or second $O(h^2)$ grade

b) it is defined by the number of shifted points in the method which also gives us some error. Backward/Forward: First order
central: second order

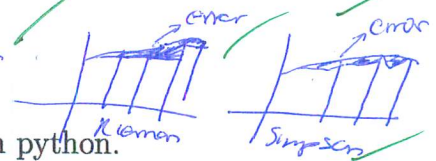
2. (4 points) Numerical integration

- Indicate 2 numerical methods used for calculating 1D integrals numerically.
- Briefly explain how each method works.

Riemann Sum: This method calculates a rectangle below the curve per each dx and sums the area of the rectangles to approximate the total area or integral



Simpsons: It's an improvement of the Riemann sum, because a rectangle has some area left on the function edge, it uses a second order polynomial on the top instead to fit the function



3. (4 points) Root finding in python

- List 2 methods that we can use to find the roots of 1D functions in python.
- Briefly explain how these python methods work to obtain the roots.

Newton-Raphson: This method takes 3 things, ^{steps/items/reference points} on x_0 , $f(x_0)$, $f'(x_0)$, then it makes a guess on x_0 to create a tangent line to the point and compares with $n+1$ and the function to achieve finding roots. Iterative until some criteria

$$n+1 = n - \frac{f(x)}{f'(x)}$$

Bisection: This method takes 2 points $f(x_0) > 0$, $f(x_1) < 0$ or viceversa to then calculate $f(\frac{x_0+x_1}{2})$ it checks wheather in which point was a sign change and does take that point and repeat iteratively until some tolerance

4. (4 points) Fourier transforms

- (a) Provide a concise definition of the Fourier Transform and explain its significance for physics.
 (b) Write down the mathematical formulae for the continuous and discrete Fourier Transforms.

Fourier transform is a method to take some signal from Real Space (x) to the frequency space (k). This is to be able to analyze some characteristics of the signal which can be done more easily on the FT space. It's composed of different sin or cos waves. It's important for physics because A LOT of things can be measure as a signal or spectra in physics, and normally comes with noise FT helps us deal with this things easily.

-0.25

$$F(k) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-i2\pi kx} f(x) dx$$

(i)

$$F(k) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} A(n) \sin(x) + B(n) \cos(x)$$

$\frac{1}{N}$

5. (4 points) Image processing: edge detection



Imagine you obtain the photograph (shown on the left-hand side) of atmospheric clouds, and you are asked to find and isolate the edges of the clouds.

Design and sketch a suitable algorithm workflow to achieve this goal in python.

Re-Organise in functions and calls.

